

1. Vision for Technology in Education

What role should technology play in K-12 education, and how should that role differ across elementary, middle, and high school grade levels?

Technology is an important tool in the education system. Well implemented, it can not only improve fundamental educational outcomes but help to prepare students for life and careers in the modern age, with high school students' curriculum having the most potential for technology integration in areas like research. However, increased use of technology is not always positive and should not be treated as a goal for its own sake. Overuse or misuse can get in the way of learning and even damage the emotional and social wellbeing of our kids, not to mention the potential for waste in our budget. Harmful effects can be particularly strong among younger kids, and so we must take extra care with policies around our elementary and middle school aged kids to ensure they can form a healthy relationship with technology and their peers.

2. Student Devices and Classroom Learning

What is your perspective on the use of district-issued 1:1 devices (iPads) in Saint Paul Public Schools? What changes, if any, would you like to see in current practices (e.g., eliminate 1:1 devices for some or all grade levels, establish formal limits on screen time, move from iPads to Chromebooks, etc.)?

I am open to all of the above suggestions and think they should be considered seriously. I am concerned that the incorrect belief that more technology is inherently and consistently better for educating our kids has shaped policy over the last several years, leading to more and more technology integration. The solution to this problem of overadoption should be driven by data around what we know is best for our kids.

3. Attention, Engagement, and Student Well-Being

How should the district balance the educational benefits of technology with concerns related to student attention, engagement in learning, social development, mental health, and overall well-being?

I believe that potential negative effects of technology on attention, socialization, and mental health have not been given proper consideration over recent years when forming use policies. I want to see a holistic approach to analyzing student outcomes that understands that social skills, mental health, and attention span are just as important to a child's future success as their score on an individual test.

4. Evidence and Learning Outcomes

What evidence or metrics would you want to see to determine whether classroom technology is improving student learning and educational outcomes and whether there is sufficient return on the district's investment?

We need a broad approach that collects data of many kinds to truly understand the effects of our policies. Of course, this includes test scores. But it also includes financial data (cost/student,

upfront technology costs, subscriptions, and more traditional alternatives). We also need more data on harder-to-measure metrics like attention spans, social wellbeing, and mental health. I believe it will be critical to engage parents and families closely to gather this qualitative data, as they know their kids best and will see how our policies impact kids not just at school but at home as well.

5. Family and Community Engagement

What role should parents, families, students, and educators play in shaping district technology policies and practices?

Parents, families, students, and educators need to be at the center of our decisions on technology. When problems first began appearing with the mental, emotional, and social wellbeing of our kids, it was their families, educators, and the kids themselves who noticed first. Without closely engaging them, we will run the risk of overreliance on the few data points we measure ourselves. This can lead and has led to policies that produce worse outcomes for our kids.

6. Accountability and Oversight

As a School Board member, how would you evaluate progress on technology-related goals and hold district leadership accountable for implementation, budget, and outcomes?

I am looking forward to the results of the BIGG Goal which will provide lots of data on everything from costs to educational improvement to social outcomes. In addition, I will be listening closely and proactively engaging parents, families, educators, and students themselves to ensure I am getting the full picture.

7. Artificial Intelligence

As artificial intelligence and other emerging technologies become increasingly available to students and educators, what principles should guide district decisions about their use? Do you support a moratorium on generative AI in Saint Paul Public Schools while the district undertakes a full review?

I am concerned that AI will have really negative effects on learning for our kids. Some kids will turn in assignments without understanding the material, having let the AI do all the work for them. If the computer is doing the assignments, the student is not learning and is not building essential skills. I am open to conversations on a variety of restrictions including a moratorium while we study the effects.

8. Looking Ahead

If elected, what would be your highest priority related to technology use in Saint Paul Public Schools during your first term?

My top technology priority is to ensure we are moving proactively on AI policy. Usage of this technology is growing very quickly, and if we do not act fast to shape its direction then an entire generation of kids could be seeing worse outcomes in learning that will be difficult to overcome.